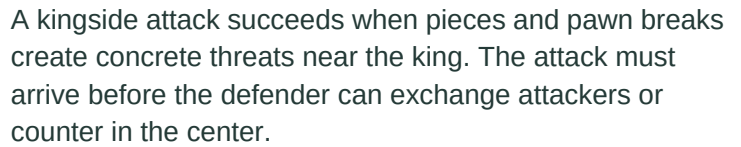


Kingside attacks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16...Bxf2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f2 it attacks king on g1 and knight on d4. Recorded reply:
17.Rxf2.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -5 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.